including Babur. This action of drumbeating amplified the fear of war cries, and it happened night after night.

The anxious Babur had begun living in fear each night. He somehow managed to send his envoys and messengers repeatedly to all sides and quarters, who always appeared to be an ally. But Babur could only wait for the help and reinforcement to come. None came.

Dejected Babur has written in the *Baburnama*, 'No one had helped or reinforced me when I was in strength and power and had suffered no sort of defeat or loss; on what score would anyone help me now?' [*]

Devoid of any hope of help from anyone, Babur could only see it as a recommendation to prolong the siege.

With a philosophical tinge, Babur has described the incident in the *Baburnama* as follows:[†]

> The old saying was that to hold a fort there must be a head, two hands, and two legs, that is to say, the Commandant is the head; help and reinforcement coming from two quarters are the two arms and the food and water in the fort are the two legs.

It appears from the primary source that Babur was expecting a lot at least from Sulṭān Husayn Mīrzā. However, he did not even send a message of encouragement, forget help. A dismayed Babur sent Kamālu'd-dīn Ḥusain Gāzur-gāhī as an envoy to Shaybāni Khān.